



Congressional Update

News for Members of Congress and their staff

April 2026

This Month's Top News



Updated Tax Withholding Estimator Released

The IRS recently unveiled enhancements to the IRS Tax Withholding Estimator to reflect changes to credits and deductions under the One, Big, Beautiful Bill.

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Need More Time to File, Request an Extension

As the end of filing season approaches, the IRS reminds taxpayers who need more time to file that they must request an extension by April 15, 2026.

[\(Full article on page 2\)](#)



IRS Partners with the National Center for Missing & Exploited Children

The IRS Media & Publications division has maintained a longstanding partnership with the National Center for Missing & Exploited Children.

[\(Full article on page 3\)](#)

Free tax return preparation for qualifying taxpayers

The Volunteer Income Tax Assistance (VITA) program has operated for more than 50 years. VITA sites offer free tax help to people who need assistance in preparing their own tax returns, including:

- › People who generally make \$69,000 or less
- › Taxpayers with disabilities
- › Limited English-speaking taxpayers

In addition to VITA, the Tax Counseling for the Elderly (TCE) program offers free tax help, particularly for those who are 60 years of age and older, specializing

in questions about pensions and retirement-related issues unique to seniors.

VITA and TCE sites are generally located at community and neighborhood centers, libraries, schools, shopping malls and other convenient locations across the country. To locate the nearest VITA or TCE site near you, use the [VITA Locator Tool](#) or call **800-906-9887**.

For more on the VITA program, visit [Free tax return preparation for qualifying taxpayers](#).

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Updated Tax Withholding Estimator Released

The IRS recently unveiled enhancements to the IRS Tax Withholding Estimator to reflect changes to credits and deductions under the One, Big, Beautiful Bill (OBBB), including no tax on tips, no tax on overtime, and other tax benefits.

The **IRS Tax Withholding Estimator** is a free, easy-to-use tool that helps workers and retirees estimate the amount of federal income tax to withhold from their paychecks now for the taxes they will owe next year.

Updated to reflect current law

In addition to no tax on tips and no tax on overtime, the calculator takes into account other OBBB-related provisions, such as no tax on car loan interest and the deduction for seniors. It also more accurately accounts OBBB modifications tied to family-related credits, homeownership, and charitable giving.

The estimator guides taxpayers step-by-step through entering income, withholding, credits, and deductions, and takes around 25 minutes on average (less for those with simpler financial situations). By entering information about income, dependents, deductions, and multiple jobs, taxpayers receive a personalized recommendation on whether to adjust withholding. If changes are recommended, the tool helps taxpayers complete a new **Form W-4, Employee's Withholding Certificate**, or **Form W-4P, Withholding Certificate for Periodic Pension or Annuity Payments**, to submit to their employer or pension provider.

The Tax Withholding Estimator is available 24/7 and does not require taxpayers to log in or provide personally identifiable information.

Who should use the estimator

In addition to those who want to see how OBBB impacts them, taxpayers who may benefit from using the estimator include those who:

- Have more than one job or a working spouse.
- Experienced a major life change recently, such as marriage, divorce, the birth or adoption of a child.
- Claim credits such as the Child and Dependent Care Credit or Adoption Credit.
- Itemize deductions, including mortgage interest or charitable contributions.
- Receive income without automatic tax withheld, such as gig, freelance, or investment income.
- Owed additional tax or received a larger-than-expected refund during their most recent filing season.

Avoiding surprises at tax time

Withholding that closely matches a taxpayer's anticipated tax liability can help prevent unexpected tax bills and potential underpayment penalties. It can also help taxpayers avoid over-withholding and increase take-home pay throughout the year. To get the most accurate results, taxpayers should gather recent pay statements and a copy of their latest federal income tax return before using the estimator.

For more information on the IRS Tax Withholding Estimator, review the **Tax Withholding Estimator FAQs** at IRS.gov.

Need more time to file, request an extension

As the end of filing season approaches, the IRS reminds taxpayers who need more time to file that they must **request an extension** by April 15, 2026.

Taxpayers who timely request an extension will have until Oct. 15, 2026, to file their federal income tax return without late filing penalties.

An extension provides extra time to file, not additional time to pay. Taxes owed are still due by April 15. To avoid or minimize penalties and interest, taxpayers should estimate their total tax liability, subtract any payments already made, and pay the remaining balance by the deadline.

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Ways to request an extension to Oct. 15

- › Use **IRS Free File**. All individual filers, regardless of income, can use IRS Free File guided software at IRS.gov to electronically request an extension at no cost.
- › Use **Free File Fillable Forms**. Taxpayers can complete and submit **Form 4868, Application for Automatic Extension of Time To File U.S. Individual Income Tax Return**, electronically regardless of income.
- › Pay online and select “extension.” Taxpayers who pay all or part of what they owe using **IRS online payment options**, including IRS Online Account, Direct Pay, or if they are already enrolled in the Electronic Federal Tax Payment System, they can select “extension” as the reason for the payment. This automatically generates an extension; no additional forms are required. Taxpayers should keep their confirmation number in their records.
- › File Form 4868 by mail by April 15. Taxpayers can complete and mail **Form 4868, Application for Automatic Extension of Time To File U.S. Individual Income Tax Return**, to the address listed in the form instructions.

Automatic extensions for certain taxpayers

Some taxpayers automatically receive additional time to file, even if they do not request an extension:

- › Members of the military on duty outside the United States and Puerto Rico receive an automatic two-month extension to file, until June 15. However, tax payments are still due April 15 to avoid interest.
- › Taxpayers serving in **combat zones** generally have at least 180 days after leaving the combat zone to file returns and pay any taxes due.
- › **U.S. citizens and resident aliens** who live and work outside of the United States and Puerto Rico receive an **automatic two-month extension of time to file, until June 15**. Interest will still apply to payment received after April 15.
- › Taxpayers in certain federally declared disaster areas may receive additional time to file and pay. Those eligible do not need to request an extension. Information on the most recent **tax relief for disaster situations** is available on IRS.gov.

Payment options

The IRS offers several options to make a payment and get the automatic filing extension:

- › **IRS Individual Online Account**
- › **IRS Direct Pay**
- › **Electronic Federal Tax Payment System**
- › **Credit card, debit card, or digital wallet**

Additional Links

- › **Form 4868, Application for Automatic Extension of Time To File U.S. Individual Income Tax Return**
- › **Publication 54, Tax Guide for U.S. Citizens and Resident Aliens Abroad**
- › **Tax information for members of the military** provides general information for members of the U.S. Armed Forces and their families

IRS Media & Publications Partnership with the National Center for Missing & Exploited Children

For more than two decades, the IRS Media & Publications (M&P) division has maintained a longstanding partnership with the National Center for Missing & Exploited Children (NCMEC) to increase public awareness of missing children and support recovery efforts nationwide.

Through this collaboration, the IRS includes photographs and case information of missing children in select tax products and publications. Since the program began, the IRS has featured more than 9,900 missing children and aided more than 8,000 recoveries to date.

The program leverages existing print production processes to maximize exposure without additional cost to taxpayers. Because IRS forms and publications are produced in fixed page counts, any unused or filler space can display missing child alerts.

For the first time in history, the partnership has recently incorporated geolocation-enabled QR codes printed alongside featured children. When scanned, these codes display additional information about missing children within a 50-mile radius of the user, expanding awareness beyond a single case and modernizing outreach efforts. Adding the geolocator code to envelopes, thank you cards, order slips and other products increases the exposure and recovery opportunities. The broader the distribution, the greater the likelihood that someone may recognize a child and provide critical information that leads to recovery.

This collaboration is a practical and enduring public service initiative. By using existing communication platforms and evolving technology, IRS Media & Publications continues to support a national effort to reunite families and protect children.

Bank Secrecy Act Data: A Critical Tool in IRS-CI Investigations

Bank Secrecy Act (BSA) filings are a critical tool used by IRS Criminal Investigation (IRS-CI) to identify and investigate complex financial crimes. These filings—including Suspicious Activity Reports (SARs), Currency Transaction Reports (CTRs), and Forms 8300—provide financial intelligence that helps investigators detect patterns, develop leads, and uncover criminal networks.

IRS-CI Chief Guy Ficco emphasized that BSA filings are often the first indicator that financial crime may be occurring. “BSA data is often the first signal that something isn’t right,” Ficco said, noting that these filings help investigators identify patterns, follow financial trails, and build cases that protect taxpayers. He added that criminals frequently structure transactions to avoid detection, but Currency Transaction Reports provide concrete transactional data that can serve as key evidence in proving criminal activity.

Data from fiscal year 2025 highlights the significant role BSA information plays in IRS-CI investigations across the country. Approximately 89% of IRS-CI investigations had BSA filings

associated with the primary subject, and 11.7% of investigations originated directly from a BSA filing.

Financial institutions serve critical partners in this work. SARs help IRS-CI identify emerging threats, trace illicit funds, and generate investigative leads, while CTRs provide standardized transaction data that allows investigators to reconstruct timelines and connect related individuals and accounts.

Over the past three fiscal years, IRS-CI investigations that utilized BSA data have helped target billions of dollars in alleged fraudulent activity, seize \$799 million in assets tied to criminal activity, obtain \$498 million in restitution for crime victims, and achieve a 98% conviction rate with an average prison sentence of approximately 42 months.

IRS-CI also works closely with law enforcement partners through SAR Review Teams operating in all 94 federal judicial districts, where agencies analyze BSA filings and identify investigative leads. These collaborative efforts contributed to the seizure of \$385 million in illicit funds and assets from FY2023 through FY2025.

Through these partnerships and its expertise in financial investigations, IRS-CI continues to leverage BSA data to disrupt criminal networks, protect victims, and safeguard the integrity of the U.S. financial system.

IRS-CI is the law enforcement arm of the IRS, responsible for conducting financial crime investigations, including tax fraud, narcotics trafficking, money laundering, public corruption, healthcare fraud, identity theft and more. It is the only federal law enforcement agency with investigative jurisdiction over violations of the Internal Revenue Code. IRS-CI has 18 field offices located across the U.S. and maintains an international presence through attaché posts abroad.

Visit [IRS-CI's landing page on IRS.gov](#) to view our annual reports, as well as press releases for recent investigative actions.

For the latest IRS-CI news, follow the [IRS-CI LinkedIn page](#).

Contact my local office internationally

The IRS launched a new live text chat support service for individual taxpayers living outside the United States who need assistance with transcripts and amended returns.

International taxpayers can access the live text chat at [Contact My Local Office Internationally](#). Live chat is available Monday through Friday from 6 a.m. to 11 p.m. EDT. For account-specific questions, taxpayers will need to verify their identity using ID.me.

At this time, assistors can only answer specific questions about:

- › Status of amended returns.
- › Amended return process timeline.
- › Help with requesting a transcript.

TACs offer Saturday hours this filing season

The IRS will offer special **Saturday hours** at many Taxpayer Assistance Centers (TACs) across the country. These openings will be from 9 a.m. to 4 p.m. on April 11, April 25, May 30 and June 27. Taxpayers can make a Saturday appointment to receive all services routinely provided at each office, except for cash payments. Taxpayers can make an appointment by visiting [IRS.gov/help/contact-your-local-irs-office](#).

As a reminder, tax return preparation isn’t offered at IRS TACs. Taxpayers can review available tax filing options on IRS.gov. Those visiting a TAC for tax account-related services must verify their identity. Visitors must bring two forms of identification. If they have questions about a tax return, they should bring a copy of it or its digital image.

To receive services during regular operating hours, Monday through Friday, 8:30 a.m. to 4:30 p.m., call **844-545-5640** to make an appointment.

Dirty Dozen tax scams for 2026: IRS reminds taxpayers to watch out for dangerous threats

The IRS announced its annual Dirty Dozen list of tax scams for 2026 that threaten the tax and financial information of taxpayers, businesses, and tax professionals.

The Dirty Dozen is part of a broader campaign conducted through the [Security Summit](#) to educate taxpayers about identity theft schemes and other forms of fraud, particularly during filing season.

A notable change to this year's list is the addition of abusive undistributed long-term capital gains claims as item #6, replacing prior fuel tax credit concerns, as the IRS sees an increase in overstated or fabricated claims tied to Form 2439, Notice to Shareholder of Undistributed Long-Term Capital Gains. The IRS advises all taxpayers to remain cautious year-round, as criminals will always be on the lookout for new ways to obtain money, personal identifiable information, and data.

The 2026 Dirty Dozen: 12 key scams to watch for

1. IRS impersonation by email and text (phishing + smishing)
2. AI-enabled IRS impersonation by phone (robocalls, voice mimicry, spoofed caller ID)
3. Fake charities
4. Misleading tax advice on social media
5. Identity theft involving IRS Online Account access
6. Abusive undistributed long-term capital gains claims
7. Bogus "Self-Employment Tax Credit" promotion
8. Ghost preparers
9. Non-cash charitable contribution schemes
10. Overstated withholding schemes (fabricated wage/withholding data)
11. Spear-phishing and malware campaigns targeting tax professionals
12. Aggressive or misleading Offer in Compromise marketing ("OIC mills")

For more information on the tax scams listed, how taxpayers can protect themselves, and ways to report tax schemes, visit [Dirty Dozen tax scams for 2026: IRS reminds taxpayers to watch out for dangerous threats](#).



IRS Tips | Helpful taxpayer information on a variety of topics

IRS new web page streamlines tax fraud and scam reporting

The IRS recently launched a new web page that allows taxpayers to confidentially report suspected tax fraud, scams, evasion, or other tax-related illegal activities, as well as internal-facing improvements that will enhance how referrals are used to stop illegal activity.

The new web page consolidates multiple IRS fraud-reporting options into a single, centralized location, making it easier for taxpayers to report suspicious activity. The web page can be found by selecting the new 'Report Fraud' button on the IRS.gov homepage or at [IRS.gov/SubmitATip](#).

Taxpayers are encouraged to report suspected tax-related wrongdoing as soon as possible to help the IRS address fraud and noncompliance.

The new web page is only an initial improvement to the IRS's fraud reporting process. Over the longer term, the IRS plans to streamline fraud reporting by reducing forms, automating processes, and using modern case management software.

These changes will address historic challenges the IRS has faced in using referrals. Creating fewer work streams, simplifying how taxpayers submit referrals, and making processing of claims more efficient will improve how IRS uses referrals in years to come.



[IRS.gov/SubmitATip](#)

IN THE NEWS

[Update on IRS Commissioner position](#)

[Written Testimony of the IRS CEO before the House Ways and Means Committee](#)

[2026 IRS Nationwide Tax Forum registration is now open](#)

[IRS published schedule taxpayers will use to claim deductions on no tax on tips, no tax on overtime, no tax on car loans, no tax on seniors](#)

[Treasury, IRS issue proposed regulations to make it easier for digital asset brokers to provide 1099-DA statements electronically](#)

[Treasury, IRS issue proposed regulations on how to open initial Trump Accounts under the One, Big, Beautiful Bill](#)

[Treasury, IRS issue proposed regulations for Trump Accounts contribution pilot program, Treasury Department to deposit \\$1,000 into the account of each eligible child](#)

[Understanding your CP53E notice \(Updating Direct Deposit Info\)](#)

Get Help
on IRS.gov



Online Accounts

- › [Online account for individuals](#)
- › [Business Tax Account](#)
- › [Tax Pro Account](#)

Filing And Payments

- › [E-file: Do your taxes for free](#)
- › [Payments](#)
- › [Where's My Refund?](#)
- › [Where's my application for tax-exempt status?](#)

Online Tools

- › [Order forms and publications by U.S. mail](#)
- › [Tax Exempt Organization Search](#)
- › [Tax Withholding Estimator](#)
- › [IRS Local Office Locator](#)
- › [Employer identification number](#)
- › [Tools](#)

Resources

- › [One, Big, Beautiful Bill provisions](#)
- › [Forms & instructions](#)
- › [Report fraud](#)
- › [Identity Theft Central](#)
- › [Revocation or denial of passport](#)
- › [Self-employed individuals tax center](#)

Assistance

- › [Congressional Affairs Program](#)
- › [Taxpayer Advocate Service \(TAS\)](#)

Connect with IRS



Connect with TAS



The **IRS Congressional Update** is a monthly newsletter prepared by IRS Legislative Affairs. For information on resolving taxpayer account issues, visit the [Taxpayer Advocate Service](#).